

M A C C E S S I N C .

Private Security LA Worldwide | PPO #122729 | BSIS-Authorized Training Provider

Appropriate Use of Force

Pre-Registration Training — BSIS Required

Duration: 5 Hours

Authority: BPC §7583.7 | DCA AUF Manual July 2023

MACCESS INC.

June 2026



MODULE 1

Legal Standards for Use of Force

BPC §7583.7 | DCA AUF Manual July 2023

Governing Statutes

California Penal Code §835a — Legal use of force to effect arrest

PC §836 — Peace officer arrest authority

PC §837 — Citizen arrest authority (security guard standard)

BPC §7583.7 — BSIS training mandate for use of force

Title 16 CCR §643 — Certificate and record-keeping requirements

4th Amendment (US Constitution) — Unreasonable seizure prohibition

Contractual & Employer Obligations

PPO (MACCESS INC.) bound by client site use-of-force policies

Guard may NEVER exceed force authorized by contract or law

Employer is vicariously liable for unauthorized force by guards

All incidents reportable to BSIS per BPC §7583.2

On-site supervisor must document and report within 24 hours

Incident reports must be accurate, complete, and timely

Criminal Exposure

Battery (PC §242) — unlawful use of force against a person

Assault (PC §240) — attempt or threat to apply force

Kidnapping (PC §207) — unlawfully moving a detained person

False imprisonment (PC §236) — unlawful detention

Criminal prosecution is independent of civil suits

Guard card suspension or revocation (BPC §480)

Civil Exposure

Excessive force tort — compensatory and punitive damages

Wrongful death — liability if force results in death

Intentional infliction of emotional distress

Employer (PPO) vicarious liability for guard's actions

Insurance consequences for MACCESS INC.

Loss of guard card, PPO license, and employment



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MODULE 2

Objectively Reasonable Force (In-Person)

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What Is Objectively Reasonable? — Graham v. Connor (1989)

Force must be judged from perspective of a reasonable officer on scene — NOT with 20/20 hindsight

Factors: severity of the offense, whether subject poses immediate threat, whether subject is actively resisting

The standard is objective: would a reasonable person in the guard's position have used this level of force?

Restraint Techniques

Verbal commands — ALWAYS the first option

Control holds — used only when justified

Handcuffing — only after lawful citizen's arrest

Document all physical contact in incident report

Force Continuum Options

1. Officer presence and verbal commands
2. Soft empty-hand techniques (escort, control)
3. Hard empty-hand techniques (strikes — rarely justified)
4. Weapons (only if separately licensed and authorized)

Force Options — Key Rules

Force must be proportionate to the specific threat

Escalate only as threat level increases

DE-ESCALATE immediately when threat subsides

Never use force as punishment or retaliation

Never use force against passive resistance alone

Document exact force used and exact reason in report

Notify supervisor immediately after any use of force

Scenario Analysis (In-Person Discussion)

Scenario A: Subject verbally refuses to leave — appropriate response?

Scenario B: Subject pushes guard once — escalation options?

Scenario C: Subject flees after being stopped — chase or release?

Scenario D: Subject is visibly intoxicated and combative — steps?

Scenario E: Guard is threatened with an object — justification?

All scenarios evaluated under objectively reasonable standard



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MODULE 3

Duty to Intercede & Supervisory Responsibilities

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What Is the Duty to Intercede?

A guard who WITNESSES another guard using excessive force has a duty to intervene

Failure to intercede = complicity in the unlawful act

Applies even if the officer using excessive force is a supervisor

Intercede verbally first: 'Stop — that is excessive force'

Document the incident and report to BSIS per BPC §7583.2

Protect yourself legally: report in writing immediately

Supervisory Responsibilities

Supervisors must report all use-of-force incidents per BPC §7583.2, §7583.4

Required to submit written incident reports within required timeframes

Must review all force incidents for policy compliance

Train officers under them on proper force standards

Supervisors may face personal liability for subordinate misconduct

MACCESS INC. requires immediate supervisor notification



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MODULE 4

De-escalation & Interpersonal Communication (In-Person)

BPC §7583.7 | DCA AUF Manual July 2023

1. Self-Control

Control your own emotions before engaging

Slow your breathing — speak calmly and clearly

Avoid commands that escalate: 'Calm down!' often backfires

Project authority through tone, not volume

2. Effective Communication

Use plain language — no jargon or threats

Acknowledge the subject's feelings without agreeing

Ask open questions: 'What can I help you with?'

Active listening reduces perceived threat immediately

3. Scene Assessment

Identify weapons, exits, bystanders, escape routes

Position yourself at a safe distance (6-10 feet)

Call for backup before force is needed

Never corner an agitated subject — leave an exit

4. Force Options Awareness

Always know your next step if de-escalation fails

Make sure subject knows they have a choice

Use time and distance as tactical tools

Each moment of calm is an opportunity to avoid force

Tactical Methods

TIME: Slow things down — rushing increases risk. More time = more options

DISTANCE: Maintain reactionary gap (6+ feet from agitated subject)

COVER: Solid barrier between you and potential threat (car, wall, counter)

CONCEALMENT: Reduces visual target — not the same as cover

Use all four together: create space, call for help, communicate

Document tactical decisions in every incident report

Common De-escalation Mistakes

Moving too close — violates reactionary gap, increases threat

Giving too many commands at once — causes confusion and resistance

Using threatening language or challenges — escalates instantly

Ignoring early warning signs of agitation

Failing to request backup before the situation deteriorates

Not documenting de-escalation attempts in incident reports



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MODULE 5

Bias, Cultural Competency & Interactions with People with Disabilities

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Implicit Bias

Unconscious attitudes or stereotypes that affect decisions

Everyone has implicit biases — recognizing them is the first step

Can affect who a guard stops, detains, or applies force against

Bias-based policing violates civil rights — exposure for MACCESS INC.

Strategy: slow down decisions, apply consistent standards to all

Self-audit: 'Would I treat a different person the same way here?'

Explicit Bias & Cultural Competency

Explicit bias: conscious prejudice — strictly prohibited under California law

Discrimination in security actions = civil and criminal liability

Cultural competency: understanding how culture affects behavior

Never interpret unfamiliar cultural behavior as suspicious by itself

Language barriers: use clear simple language, seek interpreter if needed

Diverse communities require diverse communication strategies

Recognizing Disability & Mental Health Situations

Unusual behavior may indicate disability, not criminal intent

ADA (Americans with Disabilities Act) — guards must make reasonable accommodations

Behavioral health crisis: agitation, confusion, self-talk, erratic movement

Autism spectrum: may not make eye contact, may not respond to verbal commands

Deaf/hard of hearing: may ignore verbal commands — not defiance

Ask yourself: is this a safety threat or a disability manifestation?

De-escalation for Disabilities & Behavioral Health

Speak calmly and slowly — loud commands increase fear and agitation

Reduce stimuli: lower voice, ask bystanders to move back

Do NOT rush or physically escalate — can cause panic and injury

Call for appropriate help: medical personnel, mental health response

Document observed behaviors — not diagnoses — in incident report

Respect dignity: treat every person with professionalism



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MODULE 6

Mental Health, Active Shooter & Force Scenario Training

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Categories of Mental Illness

Defined in BPC §631: serious mental conditions including schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, major depressive disorder

Psychosis: may involve hallucinations, paranoia, detachment from reality

Manic episodes: extreme agitation, rapid speech, impulsive behavior

Depression: withdrawal, flat affect — not typically a threat

Substance-induced mental states: may mimic psychiatric symptoms

Guards are NOT mental health professionals — know your limits

Reducing Bias & Stigma

Mental illness is NOT the same as dangerousness

Most people with mental illness are NOT violent

Stigma can cause guards to escalate unnecessarily

Approach with compassion — mental health calls require patience

Always call for appropriate medical/mental health backup

Document behaviors observed — not assumptions or diagnoses

Recognizing an Active Shooter Situation

Multiple gunshots in rapid succession

Screaming or running people indicating immediate danger

Smell of gunpowder or visible weapon

Reports from witnesses of person with weapon

DO NOT investigate alone — call 911 immediately

Your first priority: protect lives, then contain

Guard Responsibilities: Run-Hide-Fight (DHS Protocol)

RUN: Evacuate yourself and others if possible — leave belongings

HIDE: Barricade in secure room — turn off lights, silence phones

FIGHT: Last resort only — improvise weapons, commit to action

CALL 911: Provide location, description, number of shooters

When police arrive: hands visible, follow all commands

Do NOT attempt to engage shooter unless no other option exists



Course Complete

Appropriate Use of Force

Proceed to the online assessment. A score of 100% is required to receive your BSIS Certificate of Completion per BPC §7583.7 | DCA AUF Manual July 2023.